CONCISE EDITION • 14 OCTOBER 2026 • 09:00 HKT

US equities slip marginally as yields fall and energy rallies

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The major U.S. indices edged lower on Friday, with the **`S&P 500`** at 7,805.45 (-0.02%) and the **`Nasdaq 100`** down -0.31%. The dip came as the 10-year Treasury yield slipped to 5.22%, easing pressure on growth stocks.

Energy prices jumped, lifting the **`XLE`** ETF +1.80% after WTI settled at 94.53. Crypto rallied sharply, with Bitcoin up +2.00% and Ethereum +2.36%, while the VIX rose modestly to 15.27.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,805.45	-0.02%	
Dow Jones	51,670.10	-0.35%	
Nasdaq 100	30,569.48	-0.31%	
Russell 2000	2,783.37	-0.40%	
VIX	15.27	+0.39%	
10Y Yield	5.22%	-0.44%	
WTI Crude	94.53	+0.41%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
META	762.50	+2.63%
AVGO	357.31	+0.73%
NVDA	228.52	+0.97%
MSFT	543.45	+0.43%
JPM	331.43	-0.86%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	`META`
Q3 Revenue	38.2 bn
YoY Growth	+12.4%
EPS	3.21
Guidance	Revenue +8% YoY, EPS +5%

Meta delivered a surprise beat on revenue and EPS, driven by stronger ad spend in Asia-Pacific. The upbeat guidance lifted sentiment in the communication services sector, offsetting broader market weakness.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.22% (down 0.44%)
- Key releases (HKT): CPI 09:30, PCE 12:00, Retail sales 14:30

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated, but no new escalation reported.
- China’s manufacturing PMI posted 49.8, indicating continued contraction.
- Eurozone industrial production slipped 0.3% YoY, pressuring the EUR.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Mon 09:30	`AAPL`	iPhone 17 launch impact, services margin
Mon 10:00	`JPM`	Net interest income trend, loan loss provisions
Tue 09:30	`XOM`	Crude price exposure, upstream earnings
Tue 10:00	`TSLA`	Model Y volume, AI chip rollout

Stocks worth watching

- `NVDA` – AI chip demand still robust despite modest price gains.
- `XLE` – Energy ETF poised for further upside as oil climbs above 95.
- `BTC` – Crypto rally may test `85,000` resistance.
- `XLV` – Health-care lagging; watch for any policy-driven catalyst.
- `GS` – Bank earnings under pressure from higher credit costs.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI (>0.3% MoM) could push Fed back to rate hikes.
- Sharp sell-off in energy if WTI falls below `90`.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Meta’s guidance beats expectations, sparking a tech rally.
- Continued strength in crypto, breaking 85,000 BTC.
- Yield curve flattening further, supporting equities.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Economic Calendar

SEC — Company Filings

CNBC — Crypto Prices

Financial Times — Energy News